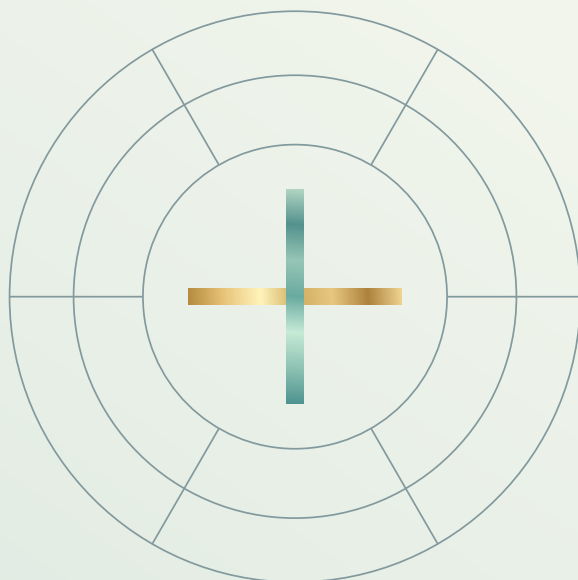


SWORD·WEAVE

SYSTEM REFERENCE DOCUMENT

The open construction and play framework.



MARIUS ION / v0.1 alpha / 11 OCTOBER 2026

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swordweave.quest/books / Light digital edition

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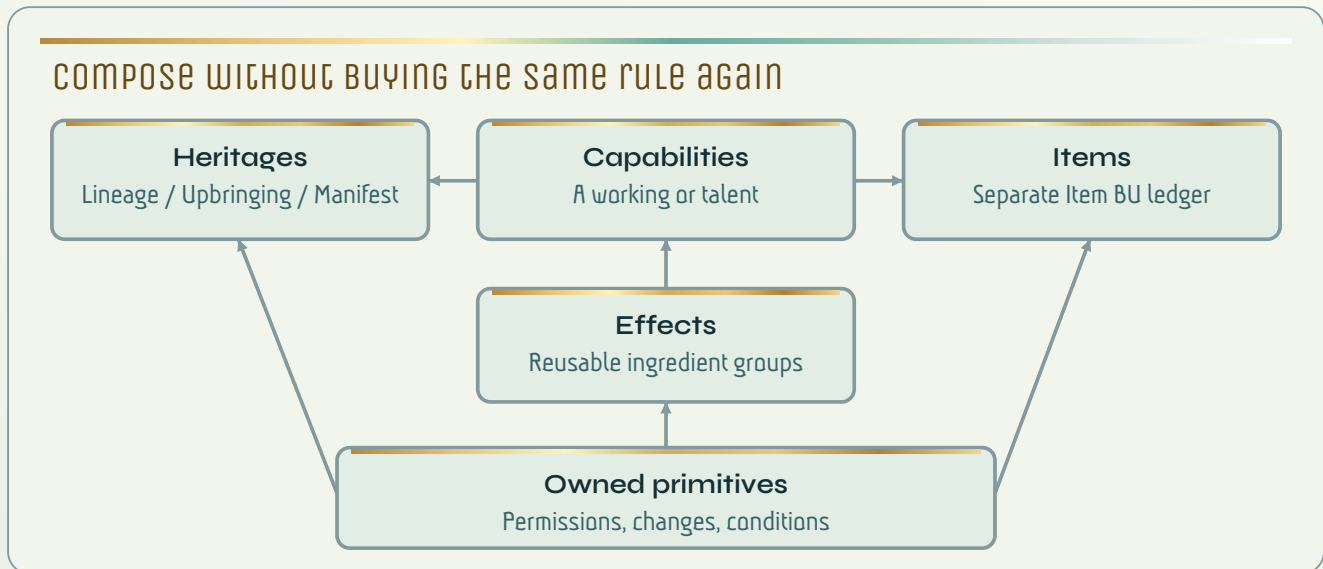
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Rules edition: **vo.1 alpha** · 11 October 2026 · Free open reference.

This document states the complete construction and play framework, including the base primitive families, characters, effects, capabilities, heritages, items, creatures and encounter procedures. It is a reference for play and compatible creation. The PHB teaches these procedures; the GM Guide demonstrates applying them. No fixed class system or exhaustive bestiary is required. One explicitly marked Vitality upkeep rule remains pending in this alpha.



Lines are references to owned acquisitions. A primitive can be used directly or through several containers; appearances do not create extra purchases.

Core procedure

Participants and intent

Players portray their characters. The Dungeon Master or Game Master describes the world, portrays other participants and adjudicates outcomes with the table. The group agrees the intended setting, starting budget and relevant expectations before play.

An intent states the result an actor wants. Before commitment, establish:

1. The intended result.
2. Applicable ordinary circumstances and extraordinary access.
3. Scope, targets, reach, output, timing and persistence.
4. Stakes, cost and consequences.
5. Resolution procedure.

The actor can accept, narrow or revise the attempt. Resolve uncertainty when needed, apply the agreed result and consequences, then continue from the changed situation.

RULE OF COOL

Core rule. Give exciting ideas a chance. Discuss what makes the attempt possible, what it risks and how it will resolve. Use the actual situation to support a coherent, engaging and cinematic scene.

The table can agree an exception or variation. State its scope and consequences explicitly. An exceptional outcome does not silently grant unrelated permanent permissions or erase an existing consequence.

RULES AND EXAMPLES

Core rule identifies the framework. **Default** identifies the supplied procedure. **Authored rule** identifies a specific component's permission, condition, limit or exception. **Optional guidance** identifies a treatment the table may select. **Example** illustrates a case. **App note** explains a digital operation.

Use the agreed procedure for the actual situation. Published examples are not universal prices or consequences.

CHARACTER FOUNDATION AND CONSTRUCTION

ATTRIBUTES AND PRACTICES

Default. Base Physical, Mental and Magical total 10; each is from -1 to +5. Relevant primitives can modify the resulting values. Use current numerical attribute values directly rather than converting them into another modifier scale.

Attribute	Practices
Physical	Prowess, Finesse, Fieldcraft
Mental	Awareness, Reason, Knowledge, Influence
Magical	Mysticism, Communion, Intuition

Ordinary attempts do not require training. Relevant full attribute applies to a practice check. Training adds PB where applicable; expertise uses twice PB where granted. Grants that establish the same training do not automatically add PB repeatedly. An explicit numerical bonus follows its own authored rule.

BUILD UNITS AND COMPONENTS

BU pays for acquisition of reusable primitives. A default level I foundation has 25 BU. Item BU is separate. Agree custom or higher-level starting budgets with the DM.

A primitive establishes a reusable permission or rule. Effects group ingredients or outcomes; capabilities organize complete workings. Lineage, upbringing and manifest organize ancestry, experience and current expression. Their names do not grant mechanics beyond their stated content.

A character foundation requires owned positive verb and domain access in the character build; items do not satisfy this requirement. Missing range and output categories receive the zero-BU Touch and IdY baselines.

Reusing an owned primitive in another composition does not repurchase it. Deliberately acquiring additional occurrences, acquiring new ingredients and accepting permitted mirrored drawbacks require their own accounting.

AUTHORED PRICES AND STACKING

Library/builder prices and tiers are guidance. Authors select BU prices; the DM may accept them or request adjustments. Scope, conditions, restrictions and stacking can affect the price.

Applicable contributions stack by default unless the authored stacking rules state otherwise. Enforce conditions, uniqueness and scope. Permission grants, numerical contributions and roll behavior are distinct; a counter is not automatically a static +1.

CONSTRUCTION reference

COMPONENT RECORDS

Authored rule. Record the name, readable rule, actual ingredients, recipients/targets, applicable conditions, operations and values, stacking/uniqueness restrictions and relevant ending conditions. State a proposed BU price for an acquisition. A label or descriptive name grants only the rules actually recorded.

A primitive may grant permission, contribute a numerical change or define a descriptive rule. An effect groups related ingredients or outcomes. A capability organizes a working or talent and may reference effects and primitives. Lineage, Upbringing and Manifest organize character heritage. Items carry their own ingredients and accounting. These containers do not automatically create additional acquisitions or permission grants.

Reusing the same acquired primitive in several compositions does not repurchase it. Deliberately acquired additional occurrences follow their authored rules and acquisition costs. Resolve overlapping references against the actual acquisitions rather than treating every appearance as another free contribution.

FIND THE BASE DEFINITIONS

The primitive reference below reproduces the principal 29 families, bound access-tier meanings, reach/output ladders and core grant examples. Finished catalogue options and forks are supplementary. A family label alone is not a permission; read the actual subject, recipient, conditions and scope.

CONSTRUCT AN EFFECT OR CAPABILITY

1. Describe the intended result.
2. Identify the ordinary circumstances and extraordinary access supporting it.
3. Select acquired primitives and, where useful, related effects.
4. Specify actual grants/changes and applicable recipients, conditions, stacking and limits.
5. Describe the normal use or trigger and any duration/continuation requirements.
6. Identify which details are fixed by the construction and which are appraised for each attempted use.
7. Review the definition and acquisition accounting with the table; test contrasting uses.

A capability need not contain a separately named effect. Neither container grants mechanics absent from its actual ingredients or descriptive rules. A new arrangement of existing purchases is not itself a new purchase of those ingredients.

CONSTRUCT A HERITAGE OR CHARACTER

For a heritage, choose Lineage, Upbringing or Manifest according to its narrative purpose. Describe the heritage, select actual ingredients/capabilities, identify acquisitions and record any genuine drawbacks. Review the resulting scope and suggested cost. A descriptive history need not grant mechanical benefits.

For a character, agree the starting budget/level, allocate base attributes, choose the proficient attribute and practice training, establish owned positive verb/domain access, acquire the chosen ingredients, organize heritage/capabilities, then resolve the final sheet. Keep Item BU and equipment accounting separate. Check derived formulas, active modifiers and consequences. A player may use an existing creation, adapt it or author one.

Checked example. Mira's upbringing organizes Verb II (8), Water domain I (4) and Knowledge proficiency (4): 16 BU. Near Range (4) and d8 (4) bring her total to 24/25 BU. Organizing Water/Verb/Near in Guided Water and River Hand does not change that acquisition total. Her attribute allocation and derived values appear in the PHB character example.

KEEP THE THREE QUESTIONS SEPARATE

Creature BU

Chosen base × quantity
Build spent / remaining separate

Item BU

Equipment × quantity
Do not count it twice

Execution Cost

Agreed for actual use
Mechanical / restrictive / narrative

Appraisal multiplies chosen base creature BU and separate Item BU by quantity. Mirror credit is not another creature; execution Cost is not purchased again.

CONSTRUCT CREATURES AND ENCOUNTERS

Default creature foundation — current builder reference. Choose a positive base creature budget B . Rank $r = \sqrt{B / 25}$; base attribute points = $\text{ceil}(3r)$; $PB = 1 + \text{ceil}(r)$; baseline Vitality = $\max(1, \text{ceil}(B / 2))$. Allocate the available nonnegative attribute points, select the proficient attribute and distribute practice slices consistently with the practice-allocation rules. Authored modifiers and an explicit agreed Vitality baseline can change the resolved sheet. These are creature baselines, not the player character's starting allocation or Vitality formula.

Describe the creature's encounter purpose, senses, movement and behavior. Select and review actual primitives, effects, capabilities, heritages or items that support its abilities. Resolve active modifiers, conditions, practices, output and Vitality. Show base budget, acquired/spent creature BU, permitted mirror credit and remaining creature BU separately; equipment contributes separate Item BU. Shared ingredients are accounted against their acquisitions rather than repeatedly charged through containers. A higher maximum does not automatically restore current Vitality.

Worked construction. A 25-BU Canal Watcher has $r = 1$, three base attribute points, PB 2 and baseline Vitality 13. Allocate Physical 2, Mental 0 and Magical 1. Verb II (8), Water domain I (4), Near Range (4) and d8 (4) spend 20 creature BU, leaving 5; this example has no mirror credit and no equipment. Its water manipulation is appraised through the recorded permissions. A title such as “guardian” grants no armor, extra actions or area attack.

For an encounter, record the objective/situation, party BU and separate Party Item BU, any known party size, the chosen creatures and quantities. Multiply chosen base creature budgets and resolved Item BU by quantity. Compare totals, counts and concentration of budget where those facts are available. Mirror credit is not another creature's budget. Spent/remaining creature BU describes a build; encounter appraisal uses its chosen base budget.

Worked appraisal. Two Canal Watchers contribute $2 \times 25 = 50$ enemy creature BU and 0 enemy Item BU. A party with 50 Party BU and 8 Party Item BU has a combined 58; the enemy combined total is 50. Enemy minus party is -8 , and the enemy/party ratio is $50/58$. If party size is two, counts match; each Watcher contains half the enemy creature budget. None of these facts establishes a difficulty rating.

Comparable BU does not promise comparable difficulty. Objectives, terrain, information, control, area effects, support, burst damage and how the table applies the rules affect play. Manual party totals are sufficient; linked sheets are optional budget references. Run the encounter with the shared Council then Fast then Measured then Heavy rhythm, current creature state and agreed consequences.

App note. Catalogue templates, immutable versions, independent play copies and encounter runs organize digital reuse and tracking. Publication links add convenience; offline construction requires the actual relevant definitions. Starting a digital run creates private play copies; choosing or previewing a template does not modify another user's creature or character.

RESOLUTION

PROGRESSION AND MIRRORRED ACQUISITIONS

Default. Acquisition BU, Item BU and execution Cost are separate. Unspent BU may acquire or invent ingredients during play with table agreement. Spending acquisition budget does not undo progression. The DM/table establishes rewards and pacing; there is no compulsory XP or per-session award schedule.

The cumulative table includes bracket spikes. Add them only through the progression procedure, never again to a listed cumulative threshold. Apply active PB/Vitality modifiers after these baselines.

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
1	25	2	12
2	35	2	24
3	45	2	36
4	55	2	48
5	69	3	65
6	79	3	78
7	89	3	91
8	99	3	104
9	117	4	126
10	127	4	140
11	137	4	154
12	147	4	168
13	169	5	195
14	179	5	210
15	189	5	225
16	199	5	240

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
17	225	6	272
18	235	6	288
19	245	6	304
20	255	6	320
21	286	7	357

Compatible operations can be mirrored within their actual scope and access: Add / Subtract; Multiply / Divide; Minimum / Maximum; Grant / Revoke. Set To has no automatic opposite. Descriptive reversals require a coherent agreed meaning. An accepted personal drawback remains in effect and in the acquisition accounting even when a separate action proposes another direction.

The default debt ceiling is $4 \times \text{ceil}(\text{level} / 4)$: 4 at levels 1–4, 8 at 5–8, 12 at 9–12, and onward. Ordinary remaining BU, available drawback credit and actual used debt are distinct. Creation fills ordinary budget, then eligible credit, then any remaining overflow; exceeding the ordinary allowance requires DM agreement and cannot exceed the next-level creation ceiling or permitted drawback debt. Later sheet warnings are app behavior, not permission to ignore those agreed constraints.

CHECKS AND FORMULAS

Default attack: $d20 + \text{relevant current attribute} + \text{applicable training} + \text{attack modifiers}$ versus the target's DC. Meet or beat the DC to hit, then resolve damage/effect separately. A miss does not apply the hit's damage unless specifically stated.

Default save: $d20 + \text{relevant current attribute} + \text{applicable saving-throw training} + \text{save modifiers}$ versus the user's DC. Select the Physical, Mental or Magical save according to the capability/source and its actual resolution. The chosen proficient attribute grants PB to its own save; others require an actual grant to gain that training. Repeated grants of the same training do not add PB repeatedly. Success/failure follows the working's stated or agreed outcome. An attack and a save are not both required by default.

Default check: $d20 + \text{relevant current attribute} + \text{applicable training} + \text{applicable modifiers}$. Meet or beat the agreed DC. A displayed combined bonus is added once.

Quantity	Baseline
PB	$2 + \text{floor}((\text{level} - 1) / 4)$, before active PB modifiers
Character DC	$5 + \text{current PB} + \text{chosen eligible current modified attribute} + \text{direct DC modifiers}$

Quantity	Baseline
Maximum Vitality	$(10 + \text{current PB}) \times \text{level}$, then active maximum-Vitality rules

One selected-attribute DC is distinct from Physical, Mental and Magical saving throws. An attack and a saving throw are different resolution methods; a working does not require both by default.

Use applicable combined bonuses once. Check/roll result floors, ceilings and fixed results apply at their authored scope, distinct from attribute/stat bounds. No automatic natural-20 success, natural-1 failure or critical-damage multiplier is imported; an authored rule or agreed table variation can establish its own effect.

Ordinary rounding is upward. The explicit floor in the PB formula specifies its own operation. Authored result limits and other exceptions state their own scope.

Advantage and Disadvantage

Default. Apply authored stacking restrictions, then cancel opposing advantage/disadvantage stacks one-for-one. Let N be the absolute remaining count.

- Net advantage: roll $N + 1$ resolution dice; keep the highest.
- Net disadvantage: roll $N + 1$ resolution dice; keep the lowest.
- Zero net bias: roll one resolution die.

Example. Two advantages and one disadvantage leave one advantage: 2d20, highest. Two advantages with no opposing source: 3d20, highest. The applicable static bonus is then added once.

SCOPE and targeting

ACCESS and use

Verb and domain permissions determine eligible changes and subjects. Range and output permissions determine access to reach and die types. Selected dice count, area, targets, duration and other declared scaling can increase pressure without each requiring another purchase by default. Extra behaviors can require additional access.

SENSORY LOCATION

Default. Targeting a specific creature or object requires locating it through an applicable sense. Ordinary vision, granted blindsight, tremorsense or another suitable sensory permission can provide that location.

Without it, an actor can propose targeting a known spot or area and resolve uncertainty at the table. A chosen area does not guarantee a desired creature is present.

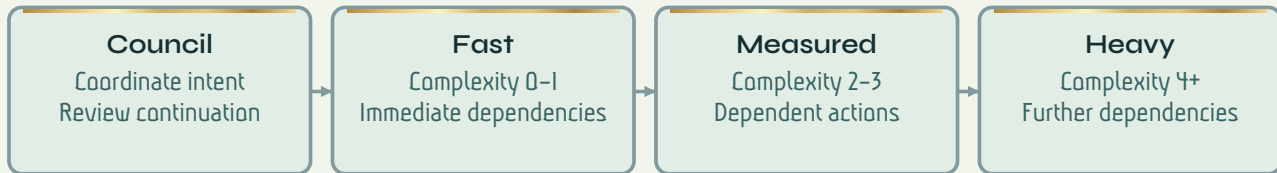
Authored rule. A working such as scrying, widespread weather influence or “any qualifying target within range” can establish a different targeting method. Range alone does not grant information or override the working's targeting requirements.

RANGE PERMISSIONS

Default reference maximums are Near 30 ft, Far 60 ft and Very Far 120 ft. Extreme permits continuous reach up to approximately three miles, including nearer targets. The table can agree broader scope, including Extreme beyond three miles, with appropriate access and consequences. These permissions do not reveal targets or remove sensory/targeting requirements.

combat and movement

one shared round, coordinated together



Complexity places dependencies in the rhythm. Movement is one round allowance; a valid reaction pauses a moment without creating a new personal turn.

SHARED RHYTHM

Council coordinates intent. Fast resolves Complexity 0-1, Measured resolves 2-3 and Heavy resolves 4+. Complexity describes timing dependencies rather than damage or power. There is no default initiative roll.

One independent Reaction Slot resets at Council. A default reaction has a valid trigger, immediate Complexity 0-1 and self/touch or a single-target scope. Relevant access and actual timing still apply.

Describe one coherent Main Intent and establish dependent actions. A Reaction Clash resolves colliding opposing intents within a track when timing matters: $d20 + \text{relevant attribute} + \text{applicable training/modifiers}$; higher acts first. On a tie the GM resolves simultaneously or follows the stronger fictional position. An Active Contest resolves a direct struggle using each side's relevant approach; higher wins the immediate struggle. Use combined practice totals once. Losing a clash does not automatically erase the Main Intent; pivot when changed circumstances require it.

For a valid reaction, pause the triggering event, resolve the response, then continue. It may occur before or after the Main Intent and does not automatically cancel its trigger.

MOVEMENT ALLOWANCE

Default. Speed is ordinary movement available across the whole round. Spend some or all and divide it among tracks and valid reactions. It can accompany an intent or be used independently where the situation permits. Spending a Reaction Slot does not provide a new movement allowance.

Moving farther requires appropriate speed access or an agreed cost/consequence. Actual routes, hazards, interference and the Rule of Cool guide the ruling.

Example. Speed 30 ft permits 10 ft during Fast and 20 ft during Heavy. Additional movement requires a further permission or table agreement.

Size	Base walking Speed	Default swimming/climbing
Tiny	15 ft	8 ft
Small	25 ft	13 ft
Medium	30 ft	15 ft
Large	40 ft	20 ft
Huge	60 ft	30 ft
Gargantuan	90 ft	45 ft

Swimming/climbing use half base speed rounded up. Apply authored changes; flight and burrowing require granted access.

SURPRISE

Optional guidance. There is no universal surprise mechanic. An ambush can justify the prepared side completing one round before surprised participants respond. Circumstances or an agreed d20 check can change this treatment.

COSTS AND PERSISTENCE

CONTEXTUAL CONSEQUENCES

Strain describes how an attempt pushes the actor and situation. Agree costs and their timing before commitment. Costs can be Vitality, resources, numerical penalties, restrictions, temporary loss of access, tasks, environmental effects or narrative consequences; combinations and negligible costs are possible.

Maintaining a working generally spreads pressure out or lowers upfront demand compared with forcing an increased expression in one round. There is no universal discount or conversion into damage. Specify the continuation requirements and the duration/ending of any consequence.

The 0–6 Strain grades guide appraisal: effortless, light effort, noticeable strain, heavy burden, dangerous instability, critical risk and catastrophic consequence. They are not automatic bills or fixed success probabilities. Consider scale, impact, dependencies/complexity, environment, opposition and urgency. Declared dice count, area, targets or duration can add pressure without each requiring another purchase by default; new behaviors may require additional access.

Optional guidance. Let B be the minimum evaluated composition and A the selected evaluated use. $\text{delta CV} = A - B$; $\text{total CV} = B + \text{delta CV} = A$. With $B = 12$ and $A = 30$, increase is 18 and total is 30. These illustrate arithmetic, not a universal spell price. CV is neither a roll bonus nor acquisition BU paid again, and numerical scaling cannot capture every contextual demand.

Core rule. A consequence records its cause, actual change, timing/trigger and ending/recovery terms. Names do not import universal numerical packages. Agree when Cost applies and what failure means; interruption has no universal refund.

UPKEEP

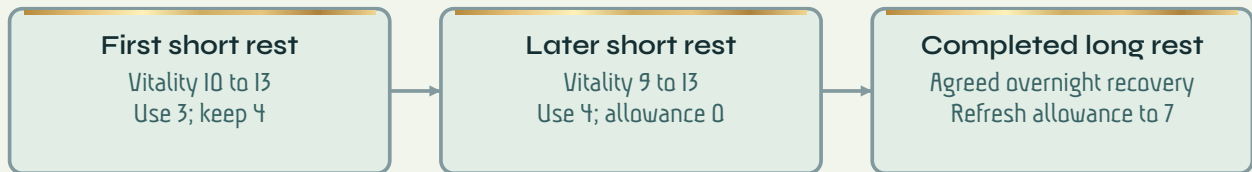
Track, duration and upkeep are separate properties. A maintained capability has one upkeep track even when it contains multiple effects. Several capabilities can be maintained; their agreed requirements accumulate. Continuing and ending follow the working's actual conditions.

Agree an explicit continuation point in the shared round, such as Council. A recurring 4-Vitality requirement can be due again next round; a loss of access follows its own duration/ending condition. Interference needs actual access, position, timing and resolution. A hit alone is not a universal interruption. An actor unable to perform a required task cannot continue it. Instant actions cannot be interrupted retroactively after resolution; resulting ongoing effects may be separately disrupted through appropriate access.

Alpha rule pending — damage-triggered Vitality upkeep. Additional repayment triggered by incoming damage, including threshold and counter/reset/excess handling, is undecided. This edition does not impose that numerical scheme. Agree any temporary table treatment explicitly. Ordinary continuation requirements remain usable; do not apply the unresolved scheme to non-Vitality upkeep.

RECOVERY AND EQUIPMENT

UNUSED SHORT-REST RECOVERY CARRIES FORWARD



Maximum 13: the allowance is $\text{ceil}(13/2) = 7$. Consume only actual healing; a completed long rest refreshes the allowance.

AGREED RESTS

A short rest is a short pause, perhaps 15 or 30 minutes. A long rest is overnight sleep or equivalent recovery, not necessarily eight hours. DM and players agree whether their effects apply; elapsed time never applies recovery automatically.

Default short rest. Allow recovery equal to half maximum Vitality, rounded up, between completed long rests. Only actual Vitality restored consumes the allowance. Unused recovery carries into subsequent short rests; it cannot heal above maximum.

Default long rest. Restore to maximum and refresh the short-rest allowance. The table can agree partial healing after a completed long rest. Long-rest healing is independent of the short-rest allowance. Injuries and other lasting consequences use their stated recovery requirements.

Example. Maximum 13 gives allowance 7. At 10/13, heal 3; 4 remains for later short rests. A completed long rest refreshes that allowance.

STABILIZATION AND HEALING

At zero Vitality, the character collapses, unconscious and incapacitated. Collapse uses a contextual rescue countdown; roughly a minute is guidance, not ten guaranteed safe rounds. Dedicate an action track to Fieldcraft stabilization or suitable owned primitives, with agreed access, resolution and Cost; no universal stabilization DC is prescribed. Success halts the countdown without granting Vitality or consciousness. Healing above zero ends the dying state and restores consciousness unless another consequence prevents it. A stabilized character can recover through assisted rest; active dying requires rescue first.

DAMAGE AND LETHAL THRESHOLDS

Physical, Magical and Psychic are execution sources; domains identify the output's nature. Mental is an attribute. Read actual source/domain scope: resistance halves matching damage rounded up, vulnerability doubles it, immunity negates covered damage. Multiple resistances do not quarter damage by default. Applicable resistance/vulnerability on an instance cancel. Damage immunity alone does not negate every associated condition.

Mixed output needs an explicit source/domain breakdown and identification of split versus separate instances. Apply final post-defense damage as Vitality loss. Healing is capped by current maximum; increasing maximum alone does not heal.

Examples. Nine Magical Fire becomes 5 under matching resistance, 18 under vulnerability or 9 with both. Six Physical Fire + eight Magical Fire totals 10 under Magical-only resistance (6 + 4).

One execution dealing at least twice maximum Vitality, or taking current Vitality to $-\text{maximum Vitality}$, can cause immediate death under the massive-damage rule. Establish lethal stakes beforehand. Use current Vitality before the hit and final post-defense damage rather than a sheet's stored zero clamp. Maximum 13/current 4/final damage 17 reaches -13 ; final damage 26 independently reaches twice maximum. The collapse clock is distinct from an outright lethal result.

EQUIPPED SLOTS

Default. Six universal equipment slots. An ordinary equipped item occupies one; a two-handed item occupies two. A higher authored requirement can represent unusual gear, and primitives can extend available slots. Size alone does not multiply the final requirement.

Load, Item BU and equipped slots are distinct measures. Equipped items still contribute carried Load. A small character's unusually large sword may be permitted with an explicit three/four-slot requirement or another agreed consequence.

LOAD AND DELIVERY PATHS

Capacity = size base + $5 \times$ current Physical + applicable bonuses. Load above capacity is encumbered; the GM/table determines penalties and complications. Equipped items still count toward carried Load. Explicit authored Load rules can change an item's contribution. A backpack organizes contents without automatically adding capacity.

Size	Base capacity	Default Load per item
Tiny	10	Pouch rule
Small	20	1
Medium	40	2

Size	Base capacity	Default Load per item
Large	80	4
Huge	160	8
Gargantuan	320	16

One pouch holds up to 1,000 tiny objects and contributes 1 Load. Item BU, ordinary value and Load remain independent.

Projected vectors travel through intervening space. Minor obstruction imposes -2 accuracy; standard half cover -4; total cover blocks the trajectory. Evaluate actual angle/path. Direct manifestation appears at a target and ignores those intervening projected-cover penalties, but still requires sensory location or an authored targeting method. Cover does not automatically grant knowledge of a hidden target.

THE PRIMITIVE REFERENCE

This is the base construction language, not a catalogue of finished powers. A family describes a kind of rule; a tier describes a family-specific permission. Write the bound subject, recipients, conditions and limits of the actual primitive you acquire. You do not gain all the examples in a family by owning its name.

Default reference. The prices below are suggested acquisition anchors. Authors may propose other prices; the table can accept or revise them. Scaling an eligible use and acquiring new behavior are different decisions. A bigger payment does not supply missing access.

THREE ACCESS FAMILIES

Tier	Verb: what changes	Domain: what the change concerns	Structure: how it is arranged	BU
I	Direct physical or perceptual interaction; simple creation, destruction or force within the permission	Observable subjects: water, fire, air, earth, metal, stone and similar grounded domains	Direct application to self, touch, one point or one target	4
II	Change existing states or properties: reshape, redirect, combine, separate, transfer or stabilize	Physical and conceptual systems: life, growth, memory, emotion and bounded local space or time	Basic spatial or multi-target arrangements: small groups, lines, cones, radii or fields	8
III	Reconfigure internal systems, impose constraints or redirect bounded causal chains	Abstract and systemic subjects: consciousness, identity, information, symbolic systems or bounded causality	Adaptive arrangements: moving zones, branching chains, expansion or conditional patterns	12
IV	Alter governing logic or fundamental constraints within an agreed scope	Fundamental subjects: existence, reality, global causality or foundational laws	Systemic arrangements: scene-wide rules, priority, state-driven inclusion or exclusion	16

These are separate purchases. Verb II is not Domain II. Domain access must identify its subject: Water I permits working with grounded water; it does not grant every Tier I domain. A higher tier describes broader kinds of change, not automatic omniscience, infinite output or success. Read the actual rule when tiers overlap a particular idea.

REACH AND OUTPUT

Range permission	Reach	BU
Touch	Self, contact or ordinary melee reach where appropriate	0
Near	Up to 30 ft	4
Far	Up to 60 ft	8
Very Far	Up to 120 ft	12
Extreme	Continuous reach beyond Very Far, up to approximately 3 miles	24

Extreme has no inaccessible gap at 121–239 ft. Its upper scope can extend by DM agreement. Range never supplies knowledge of a target: locate a specific target through an applicable sense, or use a genuinely authored alternative targeting method.

Output die permission	BU
d4 baseline	0
d6	2
d8	4
d10	8
d12	16
d20	32

An output permission establishes a die type for an appropriate damage or healing construction. It is not an automatic attack, heal, number of dice, number of recipients or delivery method. Appraise those details for the actual use. A character without an acquired range or output category uses the Touch and Id4 baselines.

RESOLUTION AND EXPRESSION FAMILIES

Range Scaling grants the permitted distance. Specify the maximum reach and any boundary or targeting condition. Increasing reach does not remove obstacles, concealment or the need to locate a particular target.

Speed and Quickening changes execution speed or timing. Identify which working can act faster and under what conditions. It does not silently remove a real dependency: an action cannot use a bridge before someone has created it.

Duration and Persistence establishes how long a result remains. Say whether it is instantaneous, has a fixed duration, follows an ending event or needs continuation. Duration alone grants neither automatic upkeep nor immunity to interference.

Semantic State Tags establishes a named state or qualifying property. Define what the state changes, who qualifies and how it ends. “Invisible,” “frozen” or “blessed” is not a complete rule by itself; it imports no package from another game.

Targeting Arrays and Dimensional Sizing establishes eligible arrangements, selectivity and spatial relationships. Define who can be included or excluded, the shape or target rule and relevant limits. Proposed actual area and recipients still enter appraisal; a field is not automatically harmless to allies.

Intensity and Damage Dice establishes output dice or numerical intensity. Specify damage/healing behavior, source and domain where relevant. Increasing dice count expresses scale; it does not automatically add an unrelated behavior or permission.

CHARACTER FOUNDATION FAMILIES

Vitality Extension changes maximum Vitality or another explicit Vitality rule. Record the operation and scope. Maximum Vitality and current Vitality are separate: increasing the maximum does not itself heal the difference.

Practice and Character Core Progression establishes attribute increases, training, expertise, PB or related core contributions. A named practice's proficiency adds PB where applicable; expertise uses twice PB if granted. Repeating the same training grant does not repeatedly add PB. Current base attribute contributes in full to each of its practices.

Reference primitive	Actual rule	BU
Attribute Increment	Add +I to a chosen attribute, subject to its agreed tier or authored limits	12
Practice Proficiency	Grant proficiency in one named practice	4
Defensive Save Upgrade	Apply PB training to the selected saving-throw scope	4

Universal Mathematical Modifiers applies an operation to an identified quantity. Add, Subtract, Multiply, Divide, Minimum, Maximum, Set To, Grant and Revoke have distinct meanings. Specify whether the target is an attribute, a check, an attack, a save, maximum Vitality, speed or another quantity. A minimum result for one check is not a minimum value for its parent attribute.

Advantage and Probability Bias changes resolution dice or an explicitly named probability rule. Define its scope and stacking. By default, cancel opposing stacks one-for-one; N remaining stacks use N + 1 resolution dice, keeping the highest for advantage or lowest for disadvantage. A static roll bonus is separate.

Perception and Detection Qualifiers establishes what can be noticed or distinguished. Define the subject, conditions and resolution. Detecting a trace of magic does not automatically identify its maker, read their mind or precisely locate them.

Sensory Arrays and Informational Horizons establishes sensory channels and their boundaries: ordinary vision, granted blindsight, tremorsense or another authored sense. Specify reach, obstacles, information and limits. A sense may establish target location without revealing every fact about the target.

Spatial Mobility and Kinematic Locomotion grants a movement mode or changes its speed. Flight permission and flying speed are distinct details: record both. Ordinary swimming and climbing use half walking speed, rounded up; flight and burrowing need suitable access. Track movement across the whole round.

Structural Defenses and Passive Mitigations establishes resistance, vulnerability, immunity or another covered mitigation. State whether it applies to a source, a domain, a condition or a combination. Damage resistance halves matching damage, rounded up. Vulnerability doubles it; immunity negates covered damage. Damage immunity alone does not block every associated condition.

SYSTEM AND REALITY FAMILIES

These families help authors express unusual workings precisely. They are not compulsory extra layers for simple actions. No universal four-tier cost ladder is supplied for every family: record and price the actual permission.

Runtime Trigger Hooks establishes an event that can activate a rule. Define the event, eligible observer/recipient, response and limitations. A trigger does not grant an extra action or Reaction Slot by itself; state how the response uses the action rhythm.

Kinetic and Spatial Control changes force, motion, position or spatial relationships. Define what can move, along what path and against which opposition. Restraining a target, redirecting a projectile and teleporting are different behaviors; their access cannot be inferred from the general family label.

Agency and Information Overrides changes decisions, communication, perception or information. State the actual intrusion, its recipients, resolution and ending conditions. Agree boundaries with the people playing. A suggestion is not automatically unrestricted control, and altered information is not unrestricted knowledge.

Structural Metamorphosis changes form, material or internal organization. Specify what persists, what changes and how the transformation ends. A cosmetic change need not grant another creature's attacks, equipment, defenses or action economy.

Action Economy Alterations changes the available intents, reactions or permitted timing. State the additional opportunity and any restrictions. An action-economy grant is not implied by a grand title, large size or high BU.

Capability Evaluation, Resource Strain, and Dial Management establishes a specific evaluation, resource or scaling rule. Describe what the quantity measures, how it is spent or refreshed and its relationship to a working. BU is acquisition accounting; Cost is execution pressure. Neither is automatically a mana pool or a roll bonus.

Temporal Ordering, Durations, and Stasis changes ordering, time relationships or suspension. Identify whose actions or effects are affected, the permitted interval and the ending terms. Specify how this interacts with Council and the tracks; avoid an undefined instruction to “take another turn.”

Boss Action Economy and Encounter Rhythms supports an explicitly authored creature rhythm. Record extra intents, reactions, triggers or opportunities, and make them legible before they resolve. “Boss” alone grants nothing. The shared rhythm remains Council then Fast then Measured then Heavy unless the table deliberately agrees an exception.

ADDITIONAL FAMILIES

Size Tier and Scale establishes size or an explicit scaling change. Define its actual effects. Size affects baseline movement and carrying capacity, but does not automatically multiply final equipped-slot requirements or grant damage dice.

Sheet Augment changes a specified sheet quantity or available capacity. State the field, operation, scope and limit. A grant of extra equipment slots changes slots; it does not automatically increase carrying capacity or Item BU.

Heritage Augment adds or changes a specific heritage rule, ingredient or limitation. Lineage, Upbringing and Manifest are narrative containers, not a requirement to choose exactly one of each or a universal class progression.

Item Augment adds or changes a stated item permission, modification, capacity or requirement. Specify whether it applies while carried, equipped or actively used. Item mechanics stay in the separate Item BU ledger; a container or item title does not waive Load or slot requirements.

WRITE A PRIMITIVE PEOPLE CAN READ

Use this compact record: **name; readable rule; target/recipient; operation or permission; value/subject; conditions; stacking/uniqueness; ending terms; suggested BU; provenance/version**. Descriptive rules are valid; numerical automation is useful where the behavior is genuinely numerical.

Example: Steady Hands. “Add +2 to Finesse checks to thread or tie a rope while both hands are free.” The recipient is self; the operation is Add; the value is 2; the check and condition are explicit. It does not improve every Physical action. An author might propose 4 BU; that example price requires table agreement, rather than becoming a new canonical tariff.

Test a normal use, an ambitious use and a use outside the scope. For Steady Hands: securing a quiet mooring qualifies; tying a rope in a storm qualifies but the storm still matters; lifting a gate does not qualify. An understandable limit makes both play and review easier.

Worked records and table references

The following constructions reproduce their ingredients so they can be used without a live catalogue. They are examples, not additional mandatory character choices. Acquisition costs use the reference anchors; execution stakes remain contextual.

Mira: a complete starting character

Concept. Mira grew up repairing canal boats. She wants to reopen the abandoned trade route and discover why the river no longer follows its old course. She knows the work of water better than court etiquette and needs companions who can help her reach the old locks.

Field	Starting record
Foundation	Level I; 25 character BU; Medium size
Base attributes	Physical 3, Mental 3, Magical 4: total 10
Proficient attribute	Magical; baseline PB 2
Extra training	Knowledge proficiency
Vitality	Maximum 12; current 12
Short-rest allowance	6 remaining until a completed long rest refreshes it
DC	$5 + 2 + 4 = 11$, using Magical
Movement	Walking 30 ft per round; ordinary swim/climb 15 ft
Equipment	Six equipped slots; capacity $40 + 5 \times 3 = 55$ Load
Acquisition	24 spent; 1 unspent; no mirrored credit

Her practices use the full parent attribute. Prowess, Finesse and Fieldcraft are +3; Awareness, Reason and Influence +3; Knowledge +5; Mysticism, Communion and Intuition +6. Those are combined check bonuses, not numbers to which the same attribute and PB are added again. Saving throws are separate: +3 Physical, +3 Mental and +6 Magical. The chosen proficient Magical attribute supplies PB to its saving throw as well as its practices; further grants and direct modifiers follow their actual scope.

Acquired primitive	Bound definition	BU
Verb Access II	Permission to change existing states/properties within owned domain access: reshape, redirect, combine, separate, transfer or stabilize	8
Water Domain I	Grounded water is an eligible subject; no permission to control every grounded domain or abstract meaning of water	4
Near Range	Permit eligible workings up to 30 ft; use actual target location and path	4
d8 Output	Permit d8 output in an appropriate damage/healing construction; no automatic number of dice or new behavior	4
Knowledge Proficiency	Add PB to applicable Knowledge checks where that training is not already supplied	4

River Caravan Upbringing organizes Verb II, Water I and Knowledge proficiency: 16 BU of the existing ledger. It describes canal work, communal repairs and the habit of asking where a current will go. It does not add a second charge for those acquisitions.

Guided Water, an effect. References Verb II, Water I and Near Range. It permits guiding or reshaping existing grounded water that Mira can locate within 30 ft. Define the actual volume, route and opposition for the attempted use. It supplies neither an invisible-target lock nor unconditional control of every flow.

River Hand, a capability. Uses Guided Water to redirect streams or transfer water between vessels. Ordinary small tasks can need no roll or meaningful Cost. A surging canal may require resolution, more time, help or agreed consequences. Duration and upkeep are agreed for the actual working. The d8 acquisition can support a separately defined water impact; River Hand's description alone is not a healing power.

Sample use. Mira diverts a narrow stream from a worker's legs. The table agrees that reshaping the existing water is within access; the worker is visible and 20 ft away. They choose a Magical check under current conditions, DC 12, before commitment. With Magical proficiency her combined bonus is +6. A roll of 7 gives 13. The diversion succeeds with the pre-agreed restriction: she keeps directing this channel until the worker crosses. There is no second purchase of Water I and no automatic d8 damage.

A COMPLETE ORDINARY ITEM

Canal hook. A Medium two-handed pole with a hook used to draw a rope closer or brace a light object. It has no extraordinary ingredient: Item BU 0, Load 2, final equipped requirement 2 slots. A carried spare still adds Load but uses no equipped slot. Its length gives no automatic Near Range permission for extraordinary workings.

Mira can carry and equip one hook: 2 of 55 Load and 2 of 6 equipped slots. Two hooks contribute 4 Load; equipping both requires 4 slots. Ordinary price and availability are setting decisions, not BU. A backpack organizes them without increasing capacity by default.

Example authored augmentation. “While this hook is equipped and braced on a stable support, add +2 to Prowess checks to hold a gate open.” Record a proposed Item BU price, such as 4, for review. The condition and check are exact; it neither increases Physical nor helps every attack. The hook’s two slots and Load 2 remain unless another explicit rule changes them. The augmented hook is a different item record, not a free benefit in the ordinary hook above.

Read a creature: canal watcher

Purpose. A river spirit guards a spawning bed beside a damaged sluice. It wants a safe flow, not slaughter. It warns anyone disturbing the gate and can negotiate if someone demonstrates a workable diversion.

Field	Complete example record
Chosen creature budget	25 BU; 20 acquired/spent; 5 remaining; no mirror credit
Foundation	Rank I; attribute points 3; Physical 2, Mental 0, Magical 1
Training	Proficient Magical; PB 2
Practices	Prowess/Finesse/Fieldcraft +2; Awareness/Reason/Knowledge/Influence +0; Mysticism/Communion/Intuition +3
Save bonuses	Physical +2; Mental +0; Magical +3 from the proficient attribute; no extra save-training grant
DC	5 + PB 2 + chosen Magical 1 = 8
Vitality	Maximum/current 13/13; unused short-rest allowance 7 if agreed rests apply
Size and mobility	Small; walking 25 ft; ordinary swim/climb 13 ft
Senses	Ordinary sight and hearing; no granted sense through walls
Items	None: Item BU 0; six equipment slots; carrying capacity 20 + 5 × 2 = 30

The baseline follows $r = \sqrt{25/25} = 1$; attribute points $\text{ceil}(3r) = 3$; PB $1 + \text{ceil}(r) = 2$; Vitality $\text{ceil}(25/2) = 13$. It uses the same fully stated Verb II, Water I, Near Range and d8 definitions as Mira, totaling 20 BU. It has no Knowledge proficiency purchase.

Turn the Current. A capability referencing Guided Water’s Verb II, Water I and Near Range ingredients. Redirect or reshape existing located water within 30 ft. State the actual path, volume, recipients and opposition before resolving. This does not automatically move a creature against its will; contest or another agreed resolution can be needed.

Water Impact. Uses those ingredients and d8 output to drive existing water into one located target within 30 ft. **Example normal expression:** 1d8 Magical Water damage, projected through the actual path. At

this table it uses an attack check with Magical training, +3, against the target's DC; it does not also demand a save by default. Appraise changed volume, recipients, timing or effort separately. This sample expression grants no healing, resistance or extra actions.

Behavior and tells. The Watcher points toward the spawning bed before attacking. It prefers turning the current to injuring people. It retreats or talks when the threat to the bed ends. A dry bank deprives it of useful existing water; its unused BU does not grant water creation, armor or teleportation.

In the digital creature editor, practice-allocation slices may be recorded as Physical Prowess 2/Finesse 0/Fieldcraft 0; Magical Mysticism 1/Communion 0/Intuition 0; Mental all 0. Those allocations satisfy its base ledger; the displayed checks still use the relevant full current attribute and applicable training, as listed above.

PROGRESS BEYOND LEVEL 21

Progression does not stop at level 20. Retain the published cumulative threshold at level 21, 286 BU. After that, add 10 each level and the subsequent four-level bracket spikes: +24 at level 25, +28 at 29, +32 at 33, continuing in that pattern. These are additions to the ordinary +10 at those levels. PB still follows $2 + \text{floor}((\text{level} - 1)/4)$.

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
22	296	7	374
23	306	7	391
24	316	7	408
25	350	8	450
26	360	8	468
29	418	9	551

Do not add a spike again to an already cumulative table value. Active PB and Vitality modifiers can change the resolved sheet.

MIRROR CREDIT WITHOUT ERASING THE DRAWBACK

Example, not a mandatory build. A level 1 character has 25 BU and spends 27 on positive acquisitions. An accepted eligible personal drawback supplies 2 credit, giving 25 net spent and 2 actual used debt. The level 1 debt ceiling is 4. The positive build is also below the next-level creation ceiling of 35. Review the drawback's actual rule and obtain the DM's agreement to exceed the ordinary allowance.

Having a ceiling of 4 does not mean the character automatically receives 4 credit. A character spending 23 has 2 ordinary BU remaining, even if the sheet also shows potential mirror headroom. A character proposing 31 positive

BU with only 2 valid credit remains 29 net spent: another 4 is not covered merely because a ceiling exists. Overflow still needs explicit agreement and must respect both applicable limits.

Compatible pairs are Add/Subtract, Multiply/Divide, Minimum/Maximum and Grant/Revoke. Set To has no automatic opposite. A personal drawback that revokes flight remains on that person; separately proposing flight for an ally does not repay or suppress it. A narrow condition or non-mirrorable rule must be respected.

AT THE TABLE: A QUICK REFERENCE

1. State an intent. Confirm ordinary circumstances and extraordinary access.
2. Locate the target or establish an authored alternative. Declare actual reach, recipients, output and duration.
3. Agree uncertainty, stakes, Cost and its timing. Revise the attempt if needed.
4. Resolve the chosen check, contest, clash, attack or save; apply bias and modifiers once.
5. Record changed positions, current Vitality, movement used, reactions, consequences and ongoing requirements.

Remember	Default or procedure
A check	d20 + current attribute + applicable training + modifiers
Trained / expert	PB / twice PB where actually granted
Bias	Cancel opposing stacks; N net stacks means N + 1 dice, keep appropriate extreme
Shared round	Council then Fast (0-1) then Measured (2-3) then Heavy (4+)
Reaction	One independent slot per round; valid trigger, immediate Complexity 0-1, self/touch or one target
Movement	One round allowance; split among tracks/reactions as the situation permits
Continuing work	One upkeep track per maintained capability; requirements of several capabilities accumulate
Damage defenses	Matching resistance half rounded up; vulnerability double; immunity zero
Collapse	Rescue promptly; stabilization stops dying but does not heal or wake
Short rest	Finite allowance $\text{ceil}(\text{max Vitality}/2)$; consume actual healing, carry unused recovery
Long rest	Agreed overnight recovery; normally full healing, refresh short-rest allowance
Purchases	Count acquisitions once; character BU, Item BU and execution Cost remain separate

GLOSSARY

Acquisition: an owned occurrence of a primitive, recorded in its ledger. References to it in several compositions are not extra purchases.

Attribute: Physical, Mental or Magical; use its current numerical value directly.

BU, Build Units: the acquisition measure. It is not automatically money, a spell resource or an encounter difficulty rating.

Capability: a working or talent organized from actual primitives, effects and readable rules.

Clash: a timing resolution when opposing intents meet; distinct from a contest of effort.

Complexity: the dependencies of an action, used in placing it in the shared rhythm; distinct from power or Strain.

Consequence: an actual change with a cause, applicable timing and ending/recovery terms.

Cost: the agreed pressure or consequence of an attempted execution; may be mechanical, restrictive, environmental or narrative.

Council: the coordination/continuation point at the beginning of a shared round.

DC: a difficulty target; a character's selected-attribute DC is distinct from their three saving throws.

Domain: the subject that an extraordinary permission can affect.

Effect: a reusable grouping of ingredients or outcomes; it is not an automatic new purchase.

Heritage: Lineage, Upbringing or Manifest: a narrative organization of actual acquired content.

Intent: the outcome an actor wants, stated before the resolution procedure is chosen.

Item BU: the separate acquisition accounting for equipment mechanics.

Load: carried burden; distinct from equipped slots, Item BU and ordinary value.

Mirror: an eligible reversed rule with actual scope and an accepted drawback; not an unrestricted cancellation trick.

PB: proficiency bonus. Apply applicable training once; expertise uses twice PB when granted.

Practice: an approach to a check associated with an attribute; ordinary attempts do not require training.

Primitive: a reusable permission or rule, with its own recipients, conditions and accounting.

Reaction: an immediate eligible response through an available independent slot and actual trigger.

Strain: contextual appraisal of how an attempt pushes the actor and situation, graded 0–6 as guidance.

Structure: the permitted arrangement of a working; it supplies no unrelated domain or verb access.

Template / play copy: a reusable creature definition / one independent creature's state in play.

Track: Fast, Measured or Heavy resolution timing in a shared round.

Upkeep: an agreed ongoing requirement of a maintained working; not necessarily damage.

Verb: the kind of change an extraordinary permission allows.

Vitality: current capacity to remain in action; its maximum and current value are separate.

credits, rights and edition

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Alpha status. This is a complete alpha publication, open to corrections and table feedback. One specific rule remains undecided: additional Vitality upkeep payments triggered by incoming damage, including its threshold and counter handling. It is visibly marked in the upkeep section. Other agreed upkeep requirements remain usable; this edition does not impose that unsettled numerical scheme.

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